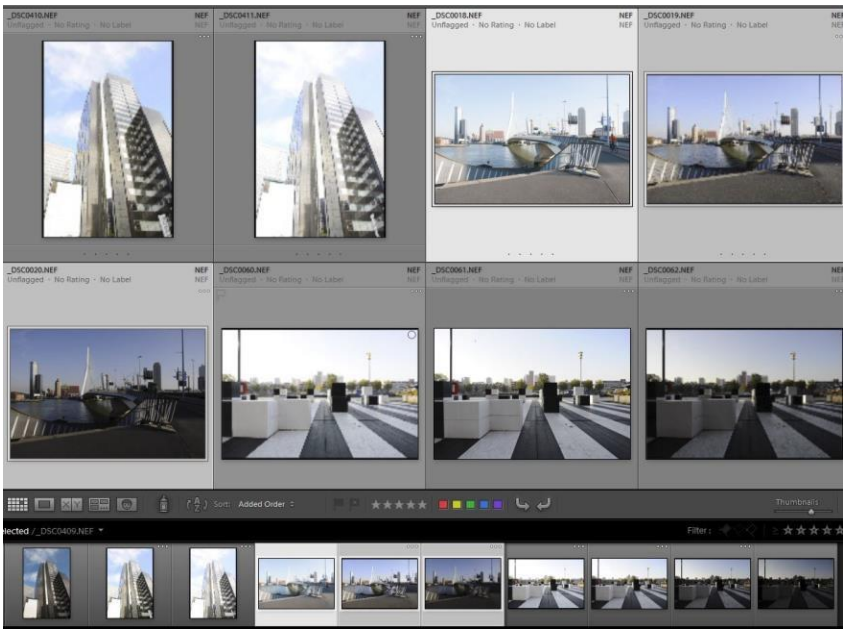
Diploma in Lightroom

# HDR and Photo Merging

## Select your pictures and merge them in Lightroom!

Lightroom lets you merge multiple exposure-bracketed images into a single HDR image. If you have an older Lightroom version, you may not be able to do it.



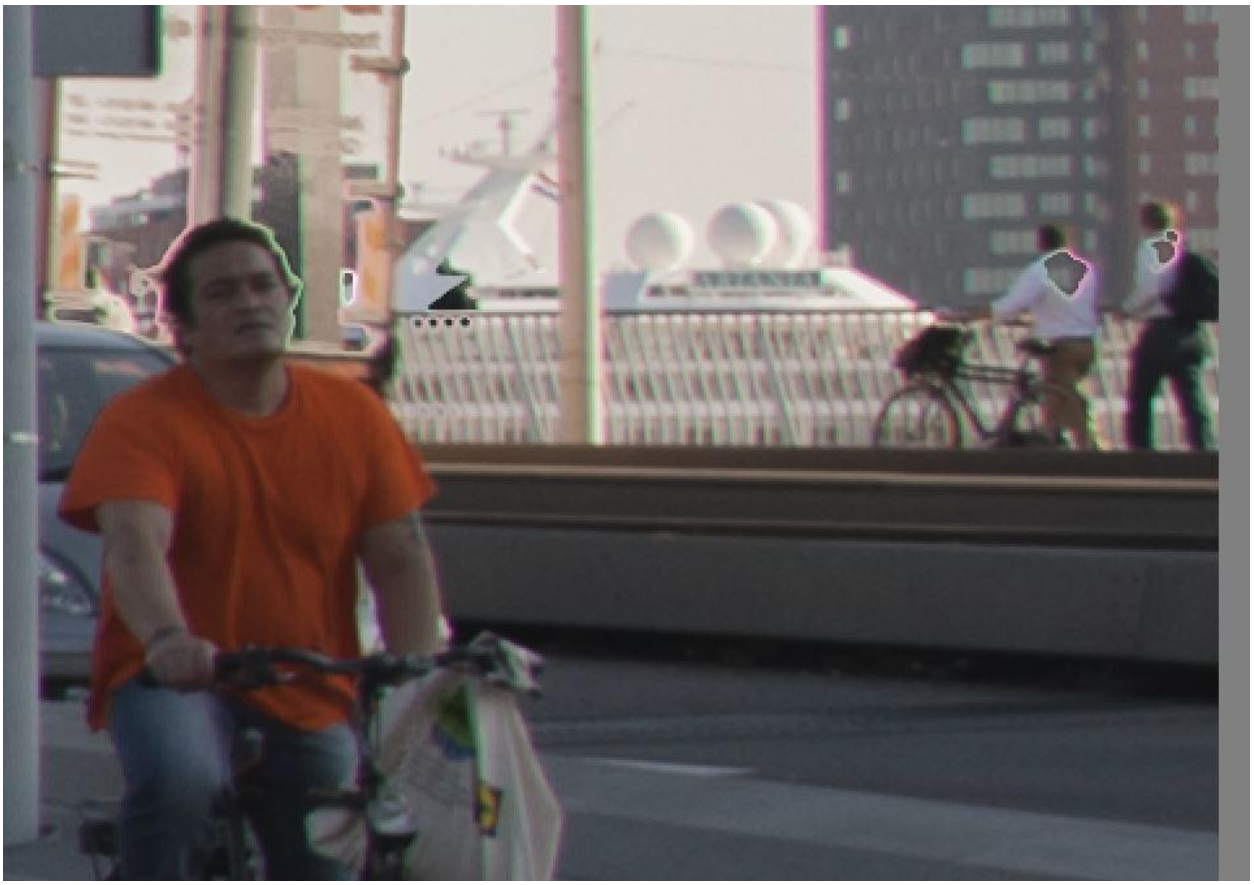
1. Cmd/Ctrl-click the images in Lightroom to select them.
2. Select Photo > Photo Merge > HDR. or press Ctrl+H.
3. In the HDR Merge Preview dialog, deselect the Auto Align and Auto Tone options if necessary.

    - **Auto Tone**: Provides a good starting point for an evenly-toned merged image
    - **Auto Align**: Useful if the images being merged have slight movement from shot to shot. Enable this option if the images were shot using a handheld camera. Enabling this option may not be necessary if the images were shot using a tripod.

4. Sometimes, after the exposure-bracketed images are merged, some areas in the HDR image may appear unnaturally semi-transparent (image down below). Select one of the following deghosting option in the HDR Merge Preview dialog box to correct these anomalies: None, Low, Medium, or High. Try Low deghosting first to obtain a clean merged image. Try higher settings if necessary.

    - **Low**: Cures little or minor movement between frames
    - **Medium**: Cures considerable movement between frames
    - **High**: Cures high movement between frames

You can preview the effect of these settings right within the dialog box. If necessary, choose to view the **deghost overlay**.



5. Click Merge to create the HDR image (.dng). Lightroom creates the image and displays it in your catalog.

## How to create a panorama with Lightroom

Lightroom lets you easily merge photos of a landscape into a breath-taking panorama. You can see a quick preview of the panorama and make adjustments to it before the merged image is generated.

1. Select the source images in Lightroom.
2. Select Photo > Photo Merge > Panorama or press Ctrl/Control+M.
3. In the Panorama Merge Preview dialog box, choose Auto Select Projection if you want Lightroom to automatically select a layout projection. Lightroom analyzes the source images and applies either a Perspective, Cylindrical, or Spherical layout, depending on which projection produces a better panorama.

Alternatively, you can choose a layout projection manually:

**Spherical:** Aligns and transforms the images as if they were mapped to the inside of a sphere. This projection mode is great for really wide or multirow panoramas.

**Perspective**: Projects the panorama as if it were mapped to a flat surface. Since this mode keeps straight lines straight, it is great for architectural photography. Really wide panoramas may not work well with this mode due to excessive distortion near the edges of the resulting panorama.

**Cylindrical**: Projects the panorama as if it were mapped to the inside of a cylinder. This projection mode works really well for wide panoramas, but it also keeps vertical lines straight.
All of these projection modes work equally well for both horizontal and vertical panoramas.

A

B

*Cylindrical layout projection for wide panoramas*

4. While previewing the panorama, select Auto Crop to remove undesired areas of transparency around the merged image.

*Auto Crop to remove areas of transparency, shown in white in this illustration*

5. You can use Boundary Warp* slider setting (0-100) to warp panoramas to fill the canvas. Use this setting to preserve image content near the boundary of the merged image, that may otherwise be lost due to cropping. The slider that controls how much Boundary Warp* to apply.

***** *The Boundary Warp feature is available only in Lightroom CC.*

*Boundary Warp to preserve panorama image content near the boundary; adjusting the slider from 0 (above) to 90 (below)*

Higher slider value causes the boundary of the panorama to fit more closely to the surrounding rectangular frame.

6. Once you've finished making your choices, click Merge. Lightroom creates the panorama and places it in your catalogue.